

THOMAS BLANCHARD

Curriculum Vitae

Université Bordeaux Montaigne
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2024– Associate Professor (*Maître de Conférences*), Université Bordeaux Montaigne, Department of Philosophy
- 2020–24 Assistant Professor (*Akademischer Rat a. Z.*), University of Cologne, Department of Philosophy
- 2014–20 Assistant Professor, Illinois Wesleyan University, Department of Philosophy (tenured Dec. 2019)
- 2015–16 Postdoctoral Researcher in philosophy and psychology, UC–Berkeley, Concepts and Cognition Lab

! EDUCATION AND DEGREES

- 2014 Ph.D. in Philosophy, Rutgers University.
Dissertation Title: “Causation in a Physical World” (Adviser: Barry Loewer)
- 2014 Graduate Certificate in Cognitive Science, Rutgers University (RUCCS)
- 2008 Master in Philosophy and Social Sciences, EHESS – Institut Jean Nicod (Paris)
- 2006 *Agrégation* in Philosophy (Rank: 1)
- 2005 *Maîtrise* (B.A.) in Philosophy, Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne
- 2003–08 Ecole Normale Supérieure

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Causation and causal modeling, scientific explanation, general philosophy of science, philosophy of medicine, epistemology, free will and moral responsibility

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- 2026–28 ANR Tremplin-ERC grant, project CAUSESELECT (€116,000). Principal Investigator.
- 2017 Junior Research Leave, Illinois Wesleyan University (1 semester of course release)
- 2015–16 Postdoctoral Fellowship, UC–Berkeley (\$55,000). Funded by John Templeton Foundation.
- 2013–14 Bevier Dissertation Fellowship, Rutgers University (\$20,000)

2012 Mellon Foundation Summer Research Grant, Rutgers University (\$3,500)
 2008–13 Excellence Fellowships, Rutgers University (22,000\$, 2008–10, 2012–13)

PUBLICATIONS

Articles

- [1] *Blanchard, T.* (forthcoming). Individual-Level and Population-Level Causes in Epidemiology. *Philosophy of Science* (Proceedings of the PSA).
- [2] *Blanchard, T.* (forthcoming). The Non-Specificity of Placebo Effects. *European Journal for the Philosophy of Science*.
- [3] *Blanchard, T.* (2025). Host Specificity in Biological Control. *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, 76(3): 691-713.
- [4] *Blanchard, T., & Hüttemann, A.* (2024). Causal Modeling in Multi-Level Settings: A New Proposal. *Philosophy & Phenomenological Research*, 109(2), 433–457.
- [5] *Blanchard, T.* (2024). Causation and the Time-Asymmetry of Knowledge. *Australasian Journal of Philosophy*, 102(4), 959–977.
- [6] *Blanchard, T.* (2023). The Causal Efficacy of Composites: A Dilemma for Interventionism. *Philosophical Studies*, 180, 2685–2706.
- [7] *Blanchard, T.* (2022). Specificity of Association in Epidemiology. *Synthese*, 200, 482.
- [8] *Blanchard, T., Murray, D., & Lombrozo, T.* (2022). Experiments on Causal Exclusion. *Mind & Language*, 37(5), 1067–1089.
- [9] *Blanchard, T.* (2020). Explanatory Abstraction and the Goldilocks Problem: Interventionism Gets Things Just Right. *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, 71(2), 633–663.
- [10] *Blanchard, T.* (2018). Bayesianism and Explanatory Unification: A Compatibilist Account. *Philosophy of Science*, 85(4), 682–703.
- [11] *Blanchard, T., Vasilyeva, N., & Lombrozo, T.* (2018). Stability, Breadth and Guidance. *Philosophical Studies*, 175(9), 2263–83.
- [12] *Vasilyeva, N. (†), Blanchard, T. (†), & Lombrozo, T.* (2018). Stable Causal Relationships Are Better Causal Relationships. *Cognitive Science*, 42(4), 1265–98. († = equal contributions)
- [13] *Blanchard, T., Lombrozo, T., & Nichols, S.* (2018). Bayesian Occam’s Razor is a Razor of the People. *Cognitive Science*, 42(4), 1345–59.
- [14] *Blanchard, T.* (2016). Physics and Causation. *Philosophy Compass*, 11, 256–266.

Book Chapters

- [15] *Blanchard, T.* (2025). La causalité en philosophie : un aperçu. In *Brimo, S. & Jacquemet-Gauché, A. (ed.), Causalité(s)*, Paris: IFJD, pp. 11–34.
- [16] *Blanchard, T.* (2023). Best-System Laws, Explanation and Unification. In *Hicks, M., Jaag, S., & Loew, C. (ed.), Humean Laws for Human Agents*. Oxford: OUP, pp. 215–236.
- [17] *Blanchard, T. & Schaffer, J.* (2017). Cause without Default. In *Beebe, H., Hitchcock, C. & Price, H. (ed.), Making a Difference: Essays on the Philosophy of Causation*. Oxford: OUP, pp. 175–214.

Other Publications

- [18] Blanchard, T. (2025). Review of Julien Tricard, *Les lois de la nature et le problème de l'induction*. *Revue de Métaphysique et de Morale*, 125(2): 301–303.
- [19] Blanchard, T. (2018). La causalité. In Kristanek, M. (ed.), *L'Encyclopédie philosophique*.
- [20] Blanchard, T. (2017). Review of Jenann Ismael, *How Physics Makes Us Free*. *Journal of Philosophy*, 114(3), 160–164.
- [21] Goldman, A., & Blanchard, T. (2015). Social Epistemology. In Zalta, E. (Ed.), *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, Fall 2015 Edition.
- [22] Blanchard, T. (2015). Review of Mathias Frisch, *Causal Reasoning in Physics*. *Notre Dame Philosophical Reviews*.
- [23] Blanchard, T. (2014). Review of Douglas Kutach, *Causation and Its Basis in Fundamental Physics*. *Philosophy of Science*, 82(2), 330–333.
- [24] Vasilyeva, N., Blanchard, T., & Lombrozo, T. (2016). Stable Causal Relationships are Better Causal Relationships. *Proceedings of the 38th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*, pp. 2263–2268.
- [25] Goldman, A., & Blanchard, T. (2012). Bibliography on Social Epistemology. *Oxford Bibliographies Online*.
- [26] Blanchard, T. (2010). Default Knowledge, Time-Pressure and the Theory-Theory of Concepts. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 33(2–3), 206–7.

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

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| 2026 | “Dependence Pluralism and Its Consequences”
Symposium “Diversity and Unity in the Sciences”, Sorbonne Université, June 2026. |
| 2026 | “Causal Complications for Explainable AI”(with Thomas Kroedel).
Workshop “Interventionism and Non-Causal Dependence”, IHPST, Paris, March 2026. |
| 2025 | “Two Accounts of Proportionality”
Workshop “Multi-Level Causal Models and the Proportionality Constraint”, University of Bern, October 2025. |
| 2025 | “Causation: Perspectives from Philosophy and Neuroscience”
Toulouse Mind and Brain Institute, October 2025. |
| 2025 | “Causal Robustness in Science and History”
Conference “History as Science”, Santa Fe Institute (New Mexico), June 2025. |
| 2024 | “Explanation in the Special Sciences: the Contribution of Interventionism and Causal Modeling”
Jeudis de l’histoire et de la philosophie des sciences, ENS Ulm (Paris), October 2024. |
| 2024 | “Can Collectives Be Morally Responsible for their Actions?”
DFG RTG Collective Decision-Making, University of Hamburg, May 2024. |

- 2023 “Causal Structure and the Time-Asymmetry of Inference”
Conference “The Future of Inference”, Yale University.
- 2022 “Bird on Science as Social Knowing”
Workshop on Alexander Bird’s *Knowing Science* (OUP), University of Cologne, June 2022.
- 2022 “Causal Modeling, Causal Exclusion, and Symmetric Dependence” (with Andreas Hüttemann) Workshop “(Non)-Reductionism in Philosophy of Mind”, University of Salzburg, September 2022.
- 2021 “A New Interventionist Exclusion Argument”
Jewett Society, Oxford University, May 2021.
- 2020 “The Significance of Specificity (and Related Notions) for Experimental Causal Inference”
Workshop “Causal Distinctions: Specificity and Beyond”, University of Cologne, October 2020.
- 2020 “Agency Theories of Causation”
Graduate Seminar “Causation” of David Papineau, CUNY (New York), March 2020.
- 2019 “Variable Choice and Level of Explanation”
Seminar of the research group *Sciences, Normes et Décisions*, Université Paris-Sorbonne, December 2019.
- 2019 “Experiments on Causal Exclusion”
Workshop “Experimental Philosophy of Science”, University of Aarhus, October 2019.
- 2018 “Interventionist Decision Theory and Determinism”
Conference “Causes, Norms and Decisions”, Leibniz Universität Hannover, August 2018.
- 2018 “Causation: The (Neo-)Reichenbachian Way”
Conference “The Future of the Foundations of Physics”, Columbia University, March 2018.
- 2017 “Is Causation a Matter of Perspective?”
Workshop “Where is there Causation?”, University of Umeå, November 2017.
- 2016 “Physics and the Causal Asymmetry”
Conference “Causation in a Physical World”, University of Cologne, June 2016.
- 2016 “A Unificationist Best System Account of Laws”
Workshop on Philosophy of Physics, University of Arizona, February 2016.
- 2015 “Interventionism and Causal Decision Theory”
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Department of Philosophy Colloquium, April 2015.
- 2014 “Why do Causes Explain their Effects? A Unificationist Answer”
Illinois State University, Department of Philosophy Colloquium, October 2014.

Refereed Presentations

- 2026 “Individual-Level and Population-Level Causes in Epidemiology”
Biennial Meeting of the Philosophy of Science Association (PSA), San Diego, November 2026.
- 2025 “Causal Constraints”
Conference of the Society for the Philosophy of Causation (SPOC), Paris, July 2025.
- 2024 “Population-Level and Individual-Level Causes in Epidemiology”
Conference “Causality in Epidemiology”, University of Linz, May 2024.
- 2022 “Causal Modeling, Causal Exclusion, and Symmetric Dependence” (with Andreas Hüttemann)
Conference of the *Gesellschaft für Wissenschaftsphilosophie* (GWP), TU Berlin, August 2022.
- 2022 “Papineau on Causal Inference”
Annual Conference of the British Society for the Philosophy of Science, University of Exeter, July 2022.
- 2021 “Specificity of Association in Epidemiology”
8th Congress of the *Société de Philosophie des Sciences* (SPS), University of Mons, September 2021. Conference of the European Society for Philosophy of Science (EPSA), University of Turin, September 2021.
- 2021 “A New Interventionist Causal Exclusion Argument”
Conference of the Society for the Metaphysics of Science (SMS), online, September 2021.
- 2017 “A Unificationist Best System Account of Laws”
Annual Conference in History and Philosophy of Science, University of Colorado (Boulder), October 2017.
- 2016 “Stable Causal Relationships are Better Causal Relationships” (poster)
Congress of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Austin, June 2016.
- 2015 “Soft Interventionism”
Conference New Trends in Metaphysics of Science, Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, December 2015.
- 2015 “Pourquoi les causes expliquent-elles leurs effets? Une réponse unificationniste”
Congress of the Francophone Society for Analytic Philosophy (SOPHA), Université de Montréal, June 2015.
- 2012 “General Causation and Chance”
Annual Conference of the British Society for Philosophy of Science, University of Stirling, June 2012.
- 2012 “Causation, Chance and Decision Theory”
Ernst Mach Colloquium, University of Prague, June 2012.

TEACHING

Université Bordeaux Montaigne (2024–present)

Bachelor courses: Philosophy of Logic; Formal Logic; Scientific Explanation

Master courses: Logic and Epistemology; Chance and Necessity; Philosophy of Medicine

Medical students: Moral Philosophy Medical Ethics; Philosophy of Medicine

University of Cologne (2020–2024)

Introductory courses: Introduction to Philosophy of Science; Introduction to Philosophy of Mind; Philosophy of Technology

Advanced BA/Master courses: Causation; Freedom of the Will; Philosophy of Medicine; Scientific Explanation; Science and the Reproducibility Crisis

Université Paris Nanterre (2023, part-time)

The Mind-Body Problem (3rd-year BA course)

Illinois Wesleyan University (2014–2020)

Introductory courses: God and Science; Mind and World; Introduction to Philosophy of Science

Advanced courses: Philosophy of Natural Science; Epistemology; Knowledge, Belief and Society; Philosophy of Time

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Editorial and Reviewing

2026– Guest Editor (with Max Kistler), *Synthese* topical collection “Interventionism and Non-Causal Dependence”

2014– Reviewer for *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*, *Dialectica*, Cambridge University Press, *Ergo*, *European Journal for Philosophy of Science*, *International Studies in the Philosophy of Science*, *Journal of Philosophy*, *Logique et Analyse*, *Mind*, MIT Press, *Noûs*, *Philosophy and Phenomenological Research*, *Philosophy of Management*, *Philosophy of Science*, *Synthese*, *Thought*, *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*.

2023– Grant reviewer for the NSF and the ANR.

2016-2020 PhilPapers Category Editor for “Causation”

Conference and Workshop Organization

2026 Co-organizer (with A. Hüttemann), Workshop “Constraints in Philosophy of Science), University of Cologne, September 2026

2026 Co-organizer (with M. Kistler), Workshop “Interventionism and Non-Causal Dependence”, Paris, March 2026

2022 Co-organizer (with A. Hüttemann), Conference “Agency, Time and the Physical World”, University of Cologne, September 2022

Research Networks and Collaborations

- 2024–26 External member, DFG-SNF Project “Beyond Exclusion: New Challenges for Multi-Level Causal Models” (PIs: T. Kroedel, V. Hoffmann-Kolss)
- 2022–24 Member, interdisciplinary working group on causation in ecology (BioDivOc project, CNRS)

LANGUAGES

French (native), English (native-level proficiency), German (read, spoken, written)